



April 2026

CONTINUAL
PROFESSIONAL
DEVELOPMENT

Welcome to the latest edition of the FPG monthly round-up newsletter covering everything you need to know including recent industry updates, risk news, mortgage and protection updates and some performance figures. This month we also have some links to useful web tools that some advisers have highlighted as well as some news around what some of our advisers are doing to help in their local communities.

In the time since our last edition there has been considerable upheaval in the mortgage market and as a result our network has seen the busiest month we have ever had for mortgage submissions. Whilst as a headline that sounds great as we know that sort of volume of business means significant hard work with late nights and early mornings the norm during March. The FPG management team want to thank you all for your hard work during these challenging times, your clients are lucky to have you.

April shows no sign of slowing down so far so of course we are here to support you with whatever you need.

Thank you.

David



Compliance News 04/26 – Mandatory Documents in Acre

In addition to the uploading of a Mortgage Offer to progress a case in Acre, you now also need to upload Bank Statements and Income Evidence to your case. The only notable issue that has been raised since this went live was that to avoid these document requirements for a Product Transfer you need to ensure that the existing and new lender, and the mortgage amounts, are identical. To overcome this issue you can rollback the case and then amend the existing mortgage details so they match your sourced product.

FCA Mortgage Priorities for this year

Improving consumer outcomes under their Mortgage Rule Review

The FCA want to enable the mortgage market of the future: a market that can adapt, innovate, and meet consumer needs and expectations, from first-time buyers to those in later life. They are simplifying mortgage rules and supporting firms to:

- Broaden access to mortgages for first-time buyers and underserved consumers
- Enhance later life lending
- Enable innovation
- Protect vulnerable consumers

Most proposals will be permission based, creating opportunities for firms to operate differently. The FCA expects firms to continue to set and manage their own independent risk appetites and take responsibility for the outcomes they deliver.

Encouraging responsible lending and supporting mortgage borrowers in financial difficulty

The FCA expects firms to monitor their affordability assessments to ensure they remain appropriate and deliver good consumer outcomes, including when they are broadening access to mortgages.

Special mention is made around second charge and how advisers and lenders should review the findings of their recent supervisory review of second charge mortgages to ensure that their affordability assessments are robust, and expenditure assessments are realistic for their customers.

The FCA will continue to expect all lenders and administrators to support their customers through periods of financial difficulty, offering appropriate forbearance.

Ensuring the quality of advice

The FCA wants to see advisers recommending products that are suitable for consumers' needs. All firms providing advice should review the findings on record-keeping and quality assurance to ensure good outcome are being delivered.

The FCA Insurance priorities for this year

Improving consumer understanding, claims handling and service quality

Insurers provide vital protection when things go wrong, but too many people have poor experiences when they make a claim. Firms should ensure they:

- Comply with the Consumer Duty where it applies
- Communicate clearly with consumers, so they understand their insurance cover and deliver good outcomes when they claim
- Respond promptly, fairly and transparently to claims and queries
- Monitor that their products and services deliver what has been promised to consumers

Following the Which? super complaint, the FCA have made several commitments for this year. They will continue their supervisory and enforcement investigations on home and travel claims handling, review firms' oversight arrangements, and drive improvements in consumer outcomes.

Increasing access to insurance

Access to insurance is key to protecting consumers and improving their resilience. Some of the most vulnerable people in society don't have that access, leaving them without cover when things go wrong.

Their market study on premium finance found a significant drop in the cost of paying for insurance monthly since 2022. Firms should continue their Fair Value Assessments and deal with any areas that don't give consumers fair value. The FCA's interim findings from their pure protection market study showed the market working well in many respects, but there are issues to address, including to close the protection gap.

Supporting growth and innovation

A growing insurance market helps the UK innovate and compete globally. The FCA encourages insurers to be confident to innovate and provide products that consumers and businesses need now and in the future. The FCA will also look at cyber insurance coverage and examine the risks, opportunities and barriers to adoption.

Simplifying regulation

In December 2025, the FCA published a policy statement on simplifying the insurance rules. They'll continue to review their rules, reducing requirements while maintaining appropriate consumer protections.

In other news from the FCA

The Regulator has told mortgage intermediaries and 2nd charge mortgage lenders to raise standards, following a [review of advice, affordability and fees](#). While the review found examples of good practice across the sector, they also identified weaknesses that could put consumers at risk – particularly those consolidating debt. Concerns included poor affordability assessments, advice that didn't clearly demonstrate suitability, unclear/high fees, and inadequate recordkeeping.

Firms are expected to review their practices, address shortcomings, and ensure they're meeting Consumer Duty standards. The FCA will continue to engage with firms, monitor the sector closely and take action where necessary to improve outcomes for consumers.

The optional mandatory document for First Time Buyers

We currently require you to issue all First Time Buyers (and any other clients you wish) with an 8 page brochure which explains a bit about the house buying process. This is just to confirm that we are equally happy for you to be sending the client the Paul Gent 16 page version (mentioned at the Protection Conference) which has just been re-branded as Finance Planning.

Launch of EPC reforms delayed until 2027

Changes were meant to be launched in October 2026, but this has now been pushed back to next year by the Government who are not yet ready. The proposed changes are to include four measurements – energy cost, fabric performance, heating system and smart readiness – and it is hoped this will provide clearer and more useful information to consumers.

HSBC Mortgage Fraud refresher training

This lender is running some online mortgage fraud training. You can book yourself on via their emails, or their intermediary portal, or by speaking to Pete. The dates are Monday 20th April at 1pm. Tuesday 12th May at 9.30am. Friday 19th June at 12pm. This is not mandatory, but just a good idea to attend one.

Renters Rights Bill

If you do not yet fully understand these changes then please can you read up on them urgently. The new rules concerning how properties are let is coming into force on 1st May 2026, for England only. Your knowledge is important because your landlord clients need to know about these changes.

HMRC Making Tax Digital (MTD)

A final reminder that this HMRC legislation is now live for all self-employed individuals with earnings (from self-employment and/or property) over £50,000 in the tax year ending April 2025. From now, (April 2026), you are legally required to use Making Tax Digital (MTD) for your income tax returns. This will involve quarterly returns to HMRC, as well as an annual return. The £50,000 threshold reduces to £30,000, and then to £20,000, over the coming couple of years.

protectionnews

Recently, an extended member of the FPG team experienced first-hand just how valuable protection can be when their young child was suddenly hospitalised due to broken bones. Like many parents, their immediate focus was on being there every step of the way, but the added pressure of time off work and unexpected costs quickly became a concern. Thankfully, they had a MetLife Child Shield policy in place. Following a successful claim, the policy paid out a lump sum along with additional hospital benefits, helping to ease the financial strain and allowing them to stay by their child's side without worry. It's a powerful and very real reminder, even within our own team, of the difference the right cover can make when life takes an unexpected turn.

Legal & General – Improvements to Digital Applications

Legal & General has continued to enhance its digital protection journey, making it quicker and easier for clients to complete applications online. Clearer questions and a smoother process should help reduce errors and improve underwriting outcomes — a win for both advisers and clients.

Guardian – Strong Critical Illness Proposition

Guardian continues to stand out with its enhanced critical illness cover, including partial payments and a wide range of conditions built into its plans. It remains a strong option for clients looking for comprehensive cover rather than just the lowest premium.

Vitality – Continued Focus on Member Rewards

Vitality continues to evolve its rewards-based protection model, with ongoing updates to how clients earn points and unlock benefits through the Vitality Programme. The focus remains on encouraging healthier lifestyles while delivering ongoing value alongside traditional protection cover.

Wessex

We no longer have a BDM for this ASU provider, but we can contact their dedicated Sales Support on 01962 893 712 with any enquiries.

mortgagenews

Gen H

This lender doesn't allow clients to do a further advance, or port their mortgage to a new property if they wish to move home. This is covered off in their ESIS but it definitely needs explaining to clients where we recommend this lender, because should they wish to move home in the future, they will be incurring ERCs.

NatWest packaging requirements

A reminder that you have just 13 working days to fully package your NatWest applications on their portal. Failure to do so will result in the application being cancelled and you'll need to re-apply for a new (probably higher!) rate.

Sourcing Halifax Green Products

Despite mentioning this last month, we are still seeing instances where Halifax applications have an A or B rated EPC, but where a Halifax green product is not being applied for. The consequence of this is that the client is missing out on £250 cashback. We accept that Halifax green products are not highlighted on the initial sourcing screen, but there will be a green product with the same rate when you source. It's just a case of clicking into the products to see which one is the green product.

Proc Fee Payment Route

Please do NOT select PMS when applying for a mortgage. Please always select L&G Mortgage Cub, as we always have. (For your information, PMS are our protection service provider – Zenith PMS.)

performance

Mortgages – Adviser League Table for March 2026

Congratulations to **Rob Chart** for topping our mortgage table. This is a record number of advisers submitting double figures mortgage applications in a month.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Rob Chart	54
Carl Thorne	51
Dan Fletcher	44
Jack Savory	43
Phil Smith	42
Emily Chattaway	38
Claire Lipscomb	37
Joanne Pope	33
Paul Gent	31
Jack Humphries	31
Paul Goodey	30
Hannah Logan-Hughes	25
Scott Sutton	25
Ellis Featherbe	24
Jim Maye	24
Paul Ripley	24
Andy Poustie	24
Phil James	24
Carrie Millin	23
Cathy Rafferty	22
Matt Stephens	22
Samita Rai	21
Andrew Bramley	21
Peter Stickley	21
Asmita Gurung	20
Dipes Rai	20
Dave Jacob	18
Tim Dock	17
Chris Williams	15
Martin Ecroyd	15
Tracey Copeland	15
Joe Maskell	15
Amit Swar	15
Alex Strange	14
Tony Hornby	14
Binita Gurung	14
Karen Mills	13
Trevor Farley	13

Surakshya Rai	12
Richard Lucy	12
Colin Mackay	11
Eddie Rozario	11
Graham Morris	11
Chris Bartrip	11
Jonathan Peachey	10
Daniel Grant	10
Oscar Delves	10
Dan Walsh	10
Bryce Protheroe	10

Protection (protection and GI combined) – Adviser League Table for March 2026

Congratulations to **Paul Gent** for topping the protection table.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Paul Gent	58
Clare Mann	31
Petru Balan	27
Jane Hutchinson	20
Ben Burgess	14
Alex Strange	12
Richard Lucy	12
Rob Chart	12
Joe White	12
Bryce Protheroe	11
Joe Maskell	11
Ellis Featherbe	10

Congratulations to everyone who has featured on last month's league tables



Well done to the following advisers who have all submitted million-pound cases so far.

Mortgage cases

Hannah Logan-Hughes	£1,977,095
Paul Goodey	£1,564,486
Jim Maye	£1,560,101
Paul Goodey	£1,370,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,196,680
Wilma Scott	£1,158,035
Jim Maye	£1,153,379
Tracey Copeland	£1,123,000

Tony Hornby	£1,105,899
Paul Goodey	£1,099,999
Paul Goodey	£1,066,449

Protection cases

Doesn't appear to be any qualifying protection yet, if you feel you have submitted a policy of £1m or over please let me know.

As with the mortgage and protection figures if you feel an application you have made should be referenced here, please speak to your sales manager to confirm if it is showing on Acre correctly.



FPG Anniversaries

A big thank you to everyone listed below for your hard work and dedication for however long you've been with us.

- Mike Smurthwaite – 22 years
- David Riley – 15 years
- Bryce Protheroe – 4 years
- Lea Pulling – 3 years
- Neil Sadler – 2 years
- Johnny Lancaster – 1 year

I have been compiling these dates from several sources and have tried to be as accurate as possible but apologies in advance if anybody has been missed from this list that should have been recognised for a work anniversary please let me know so I can rectify it.

Upcoming Birthdays

Happy Birthday to everybody celebrating in April.

- Angela Yeats
- Dave Relfe
- Michelle Barlow
- Oscar Delves
- Pete Burgess
- Phoebe Wight
- Roy Bourne
- Sophie James
- Trevor Farley

Community Support

Towards the end of last month I asked everyone if they wanted to share any charitable or volunteering work that they engage in. As you can see from the below plenty of advisers do. If you have anything you want highlighted (even if you as the adviser remain anonymous and just the cause is promoted) we would be delighted to do so, please email any details to David Riley.

Charlotte Haddow Chair's and sponsors her local Stoolball team



Jack Savory coach's Broadbridge Heath Under 8's football team. 6 wins out of 7 so far in his debut season...

Tim Dock sponsor's his local Cricket team, the new season is about to start so some photos to come in future editions.

Angela Yeats is volunteer Leader in Charge of 2nd Burgess Hill Brownies. Angela runs the group of 18 girls ranging from 7-10 years old.



Ian Court founded and organises the Starley Sportive, a community cycling event held in Coventry. The event focuses on heritage, participation, and bringing people together, with multiple route options to make it accessible for a wide range of riders. It's a great opportunity to encourage people of all abilities to get involved in cycling while supporting the local community. Through this he has raised approximately £100k for local good causes. In addition to this, he is actively involved with Nuneaton BMX Club, where he volunteers his time coaching riders. This includes working with young riders to develop their skills, confidence, and enjoyment of the sport, as well as supporting race preparation and progression within BMX. The club plays an important role in providing a positive and structured environment for children and families in the area.



Claire Lipscomb has done volunteering for The Rocking Horse Appeal, in February she helped them sell raffle tickets at the Brighton & Hove Estate Agents annual Ball helping to raise over £6,000.



Several other adviser wished to remain anonymous but wanted to highlight the work done by local foodbanks and specifically the app BankTheFood <https://www.bankthefood.com/>. Via this app you can learn what your local foodbank is running short of and then donate this specific items.

miscellaneous

Know Someone Who'd Make a Great Adviser?

FPG are always looking to find new people to join our team, and we know the best people to help grow our network are those already part of it. That's why we're introducing a scheme inviting you to recommend someone you know who'd make a great Mortgage & Protection Adviser. As someone who already shares our values and understands what it means to be part of the FPG network, your referrals are incredibly valuable. As a thank you, you'll receive £500 when your referral signs up, and a further £500 when they achieve competent adviser status.

We believe FPG are in a great place to support advisers of nearly any experience in their careers and hopefully as someone already part of the network you would agree, if you have anyone you think might be suitable, please don't hesitate to speak to your Sales Manager.

Useful web tools

The links below have been recommended by advisers as being helpful in their day-to-day jobs. If you have any links that you think other advisers would find useful please email the details to David Riley.

Mortgage Calculators

https://www.themoneycalculator.com/mortgages/calculators/mortgage-calculator/#google_vignette

<https://www.calculator.net/mortgage-calculator-uk.html>

<https://www.mortgagecalculator.uk/>

Council Tax

<https://www.mycounciltax.org.uk/content/index>

Energy Certificates

<https://www.gov.uk/find-energy-certificate>

Tax Calculators

<https://taxfix.com/en-uk/calculator/>

<https://www.employedandselfemployed.co.uk/self-employed-tax-calculator>

<https://listentotaxman.com/?noredirect=1>

Age/Date Calculator

<https://www.calculator.net/age-calculator.html>

PDF Converter

https://www.ilovepdf.com/pdf_to_word

Stamp Duty Calculator

<https://www.stampdutycalculator.org.uk/>

March Zoom sessions

Here are the details of the Zoom sessions FPG hosted in March and the links to re-watch them. All of the below are good for CPD.

09/03/2026 – L&G Ignite & Met Life

<https://knowledgehub.website/9-3-2026-lg-ignite-and-met-life/>

16/03/26 – TSB & Bank of Ireland

<https://knowledgehub.website/16-3-2026-tsb-and-boi/>

23/03/26 – Generation Home & April Mortgages

<https://knowledgehub.website/23-3-2026-gen-h-april/>

30/03/26 – Econveyancer & Guardian

<https://knowledgehub.website/30-03-2026-econveyancer-and-guardian/>

April Zoom sessions

And these are the session that are already booked in over the next month, would be great to see as many people as possible at them. Each session is on a Monday afternoon at 4pm, invites are emailed out approx. 15 mins before the session begins. If you are not receiving the email invites please inform your Sales Manager who can resolve that for you.

13/04/26 – Co-Op & Coventry (Steve Barrett) and Pete Burgess's monthly update.

20/04/26 – LV (Mike Kerr) and HSBC (Joe Tyler)

27/04/26 – L&G Protection (Rosie Hislop) and Vitality (Becky Gabriel)